

Kevin Bolander

Staff Design Engineer, AI Tools & Design Systems

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SUMMARY

Staff design engineer with 12+ years of production depth, focused on AI-native tooling, design systems, and product work built with design. I work shoulder-to-shoulder with design: shaping ambiguous workflows into clear interfaces, tuning details that make software feel fast and trustworthy, then shipping the production systems behind them. At Epsilon, architect an agentic creative-production platform used by hundreds of creators to generate thousands of AI-powered ad variations per day - 5x faster than the prior human workflow and fully adopted across creative teams. Built a reusable eval skill any AI feature in the org could utilize - it grades its own outputs and self-improves on a recursive loop. Independently shipped MakeMeA from empty repo to live product in 2 days: an autonomous pipeline (trend scraping -> style generation -> SEO content -> deploy) with real users today.

SKILLS

Design Engineering & UX Partnership: Design systems & design tokens, component architecture, accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA), interaction design, visual QA, high-fidelity prototyping, UX engineering

AI & Agents: Multi-tier LLM orchestration loops, human-in-the-loop design, tool use & function calling, structured JSON output, eval harnesses & recursive self-improvement, retrieval & context engineering, prompt design, OpenAI / Gemini APIs, local model evaluation (Ollama, Qwen)

Languages & Web: TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, HTML, CSS, Node.js; working Python

Frameworks & Infra: Angular, RxJS, Next.js, React; Vercel, REST & GraphQL API design, Playwright, Git, CI/CD; Docker (working)

Visual / Interactive: Canvas API, WebGL, Pixi.js, Unity3D

EXPERIENCE

Epsilon

2017 - Present

Staff Software Engineer (2024 - Present, company re-level) · **Principal Software Engineer** (2023 - 2024)

- Architect and own the product experience for an agentic creative-production platform used by hundreds of creators, generating thousands of AI-powered ad variations per day - 5x faster than the prior human workflow and fully adopted across creative teams (not a pilot).
- Built a homegrown multi-tier Gemini orchestration loop with humans in the loop, plus production-data bridges (real-time font-ID lookups) so AI output matches live brand systems instead of generic generated assets.
- Built a reusable eval skill any AI feature in the org could utilize - grades its own outputs and self-improves on a recursive loop, serving as the product-quality safety rail for the ongoing agent-first refactor.
- Work shoulder-to-shoulder with design and product on technical, UX, and design-system decisions; present architecture and tradeoffs to product, design, and executive leadership.

Lead Software Engineer (2021 - 2023) · **Senior UX Engineer** (2017 - 2021)

- Founded the UX Engineering discipline at Epsilon and grew a side-project design system into the company-wide core component library adopted across all products, with WCAG 2.1 AA embedded into every component as a constraint rather than a checklist.
- Established component APIs, design-token patterns, accessibility standards, and review practices that helped designers and engineers ship more consistent, polished UI without bottlenecks.
- Authored published writing on UX engineering practice; presented internally and at public meetups.

Civiq Smartscapes (Elevate Digital) - Senior UI Engineer

2013 - 2017

- Designed and built interactive, large-format digital experiences for major brands, balancing motion, performance, and production constraints: animated photo experience for Coca-Cola deployed to U.S. malls; award-winning Kinect-based Photo Booth for PepsiCo; 3D interactive experience for Accenture at JFK; CMS and API for Simon Malls.

INDEPENDENT WORK

MakeMeA - makemea.ai (live product)

Empty repo to live product in 2 days. Built the full product experience and autonomous pipeline - trend scraping -> style generation -> SEO content -> deploy. 48 styles, 460+ tests, 80+ AI-generated blog posts live, Lighthouse 95+. Next.js, TypeScript, OpenAI, Vercel. Real users today.

OSS Contributor: agent skill (published on ClawHub) that discovers open GitHub issues, forks, implements fixes, and opens PRs with an AI disclosure - an agent doing real, end-to-end work in the open.

Visual QA: agent skill (published on ClawHub) for visual regression testing of AI-agent pipelines. Playwright + pixel-diff gates wired into agent runs so visual breakage fails the build.

Wonder Together - wonder-together.vercel.app (free parent toolkit)

Parent-first AI toolkit that turns kids' questions into stories, simple explanations, playful activities, parent notes, and follow-ups.

EDUCATION

Columbia College Chicago - Interactive Arts & Media, 2007-2012. Senior project recognized by Disney and published on the Windows Store.